



PHYSICAL STAMINA

Taking Regular Exercise

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39%

ResilienceBuilder respondents do not exercise regularly

74%

respondents with **high levels** of resilience exercise regularly

55%

respondents with **average levels** of resilience exercise regularly

20%

respondents with **low levels** of resilience exercise regularly



Taking Regular Exercise



Do you exercise – how often, to what intensity, team sports or individual, is it part of your routine?

Weekly Exercise Guidelines From The NHS (UK) and CDC (US)



150 MINS/WEEK OVER 4-5 DAYS - MODERATE INTENSITY

Walking, hiking, dancing, gardening, aqua aerobics.

OR...



75 MINS/WEEK - VIGOROUS INTENSITY

Running, swimming, tennis, football, cycling, skipping.

AND...



AT LEAST 2 DAYS/WEEK - STRENGTHENING EXERCISES

Resistance bands, bodyweight exercise, free weights, yoga, pilates.

In the USA only 1 in 4 adults meet the exercise guidelines, in the UK 63% meet the guidelines

Advantages of Regular Physical Exercise

THE EFFECTS

Exercise confers **Biological & Psychological benefits** due to structural & functional changes in the brain, including:

- Neurogenesis (new neurons develop).
- Protecting against neurodegeneration.
- Benefitting cognitive function, memory and wellbeing.

THE BENEFITS



Enhanced sleep



Reduced stress & anxiety



Improved creativity



Opportunities for social interaction



Prevents chronic diseases such as cardiovascular disease, type 2 diabetes, cancer, hypertension, obesity, depression, osteoporosis and supports immune function



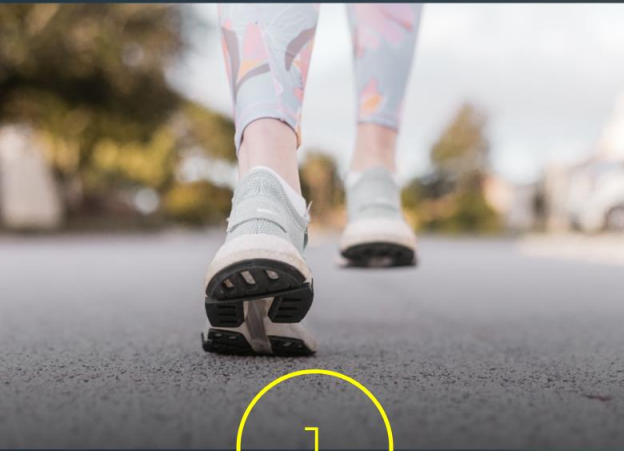
Reduces the negative effects of a diet high in saturated fats and sugars on the brain - this is not an excuse to eat badly!

Does Regular Exercise Increase Resilience?

- Participants in workplace exercise interventions have shown significant improvements in psychological well-being, as well as all mental health and quality of life outcomes, resulting in increased resilience.
- One intervention involved exercise twice weekly for 13 weeks, supervised by a fitness coach. *Brand et al, 2006*
- Another intervention involved a 24-week aerobic and weight training workplace exercise program. *Atlantis et al, 2004*
- The improvements persisted if employees continued to exercise at the end of the intervention.
- Regular exercise may also confer resilience against stressful events. A trial on US military personnel found stress levels to be inversely related to aerobic fitness. This indicates that being physical fit may buffer some stress responses and thereby increase resilience. *Taylor et al, 2008*
- A later study found that regular exercise, as well as quality sleep and nutrition, increased the brain's adaptive capacity and hence an individual's resilience. *Rossouw et al, 2016*



Choosing Which Exercises To Do



1

REGULAR & MODERATE

A moderate dose of regular exercise is better at conferring longevity, cardiovascular health and well-being than extreme doses.



2

MAKE IT SOCIAL

Team sports involving more social interaction are associated with the best longevity.



3

MAKE SURE TO WALK

Walking increases creative output, improves memory and attentiveness, increases self-confidence, reduces negative thinking, improves mood, reduces the risk of depression and lowers blood pressure, incidence of diabetes and heart disease.



4

ENJOY IT

Choosing sports and activities that you enjoy will encourage adherence to a routine, such as racquet sports, football, cycling, swimming, walking, jogging and resistance training.

Facts, Figures & Research



TENNIS
+9.7 Years



BADMINTON
+6.2 Years



SOCCER
+4.7 Years



CYCLING
+3.7 Years



SWIMMING
+3.4 Years



JOGGING
+3.2 Years



CALISTHENICS
+3.1 Years



HEALTH CLUB ACTIVITY
+1.5 Years

LIFE EXPECTANCY AND SPORT

A Danish study conducted over 25 years defined life expectancy gains for active participants compared with the sedentary group for different sports.



BRISK WALKING VS RUNNING

Recent results of the UK National Runners' Health Survey and the National Walkers' Health Survey found brisk walking (4-6 miles/hr) conferred similar health benefits to running without the risks of injury. Regular slow walkers (<2miles/hr) have increased mortality risk.



WALKING & CREATIVE THINKING

Both Steve Jobs and Mark Zuckerberg are known for their walking meetings. Recent research by Stanford University has shown that productive creative thinking improves, by 60% on average, whilst walking and shortly thereafter, whether outdoors or on a treadmill.



DAILY STEP COUNT

Most recent research in 2023, found mortality risk reduced as step count increased even at 20,000 steps. Maximum health benefits occurred at 7,000-13,000 steps for adults under 60 yrs, and 6,000-10,000 steps over 60 yrs.
Banach et al, 2023

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EXERCISE 1

Keep an Exercise Log

- Keep a record of your current weekly activity level for a few weeks.
- Record duration, intensity and location.
- Note factors that prevented or enhanced being able to exercise.
- See where you can make small changes to reach the weekly exercise recommendations.

Example Weekly Exercise Log:

Day	Exercise & Duration Planned	Completed?	Factors which prevented or enabled being able to the exercise
Monday	Swimming 30 minutes	Yes	Arranged with a friend to meet up at the pool
Tuesday	Evening walk	No	Working in the office all day, followed by socialising
Wednesday	30 minutes moderate jog	No	Something urgent came up at work
Thursday	1 hour vigorous gym session	Yes	Trial Session with Personal Trainer
Friday	1 hour gym session	No	Too tired after previous session
Saturday	1 hour brisk walk	Yes	Planned the walk the night before with partner
Sunday	30 minute early morning walk	No	Had family over for the day

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EXERCISE 2

Create Your New Exercise Plan

Using your findings from Exercise 1, create an exercise plan with a target of doing an average of 30 minutes moderate exercise 5-7 days per week. This aligns with the upper end of the Weekly Exercise Guidelines.



SET YOURSELF A GOAL

This needs to be specific, achievable and something YOU want to do. For example, having a brisk 30-minute walk every evening after dinner or swimming for one hour every other day before work.



PLAN AHEAD

On a weekly basis decide WHEN, WHERE and with WHOM you will be doing this exercise. Pack any exercise gear you need the night before. Possible examples include: a brisk 30-minute walk with your partner every evening, persuading a friend to join a team sport with you or taking on a challenge such as 'couch to 5k in 9 weeks'.



ANTICIPATE OBSTACLES

Invariably something may crop up to potentially disrupt your plans – a phone call, your partner is ill, rain, working away from home. Unless its urgent, you need to prioritise your health- say you will ring them back, put on a waterproof, go on your own, use the hotel gym. The more you push back on the demands of other people, the more they will respect that this is your time.



HAVE A ROUTINE

When you establish an exercise routine it becomes a habit, particularly if it includes daily exercise.



WEEKLY REVIEW

Keep a record of your exercise using the exercise plan. Even if you didn't manage to walk every day/swim every other day, it's better than no exercise, and you will be able to chart your progress.

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EXERCISE 2

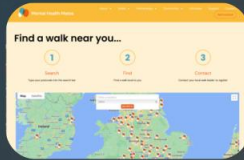
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Weekly Exercise Plan

Day	Exercise & Duration Planned	When	Where	With Whom	Completed?
Monday					
Tuesday					
Wednesday					
Thursday					

Fitness Resources



FIND A WALK

One of the many walk-and-talk peer support groups that encourage people to walk and talk

mentalhealthmates.co.uk/find-a-walk



BRITISH HEART FOUNDATION

British Heart Foundation strength and flexibility exercises on YouTube

youtube.com/watch?v=NWRI2D_vb8g



NHS FITNESS VIDEOS

UK NHS fitness videos, including: aerobic exercise, strength exercises, pilates & yoga

nhs.uk/conditions/nhs-fitness-studio



TEST YOUR PHYSICAL AGE

Benefits of body age < biological age include better cognitive function and memory, improved mood and reduced stress levels, lower risk of dementia and chronic diseases

hvemereldst.no/en



HASFIT HOME WORKOUT VIDEOS

Free full-length workout videos

hasfit.com



YOGA WITH ADRIENNE

Free yoga videos

yogawithadrienne.com/free-yoga-videos